

70% of millionaires saved more than 10% of their income throughout their working years.

You'll see that several of these steps involve saving money. That's crucial. This may sound like an obvious point by now, but I need to say it anyway: *millionaires save money*. They don't spend everything they make, and they have a plan for what they want their money to do. In fact, we found that 70% of millionaires saved more than 10% of their income throughout their working years. Thirty percent of them saved more than 20% of their income. When we asked what factors contributed to their net worth, 83% said saving money. If you want to be a millionaire, you've *got to* save money. You may be thinking, *Chris, how in the world can I do that? I make a modest salary and big unexpected expenses always seem to come up!* You need an emergency fund to cover those; get that in place first. That way, you're in control when life throws something at you. Once your debt is all paid off and you have a full emergency fund with three to six months of expenses, you need to invest at least 15% of your income toward retirement while you work to pay off your house. Remember, millionaires don't sit around and wait for one giant payday that's going to solve all their problems. They save money every payday, and they put that money to work for them. It takes hard work, but you can do it. Remember, setting the goal and sticking to it are half the battle!

As you work through the Baby Steps, you'll find that the first three steps can happen a lot faster than the last four. Baby Steps 1, 2, and 3 are short-term goals; many people can go from neck-deep in debt to debt-free with an emergency fund in two or three years on average. From there, they hit the often-frustrating stretch of long-term goals. These are the things most people spend ten or more years working toward, and that kind of far-off vision takes a lot of commitment, not to mention patience. To make the road